

SHEICK ALI SIMPORE

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SUMMARY

Founder and builder. Three years at Caisse des Dépôts: migrated a 20+ tester QA stack to open source (saved 20K EUR/year) and built an internal AI tool that flipped QA testers from writers to reviewers. Currently building **Zaka**, a real estate marketplace tied to Burkina Faso's official land registry (SIF). Shipped 14+ AI apps at Headstarter; RLHF evaluator on frontier LLMs at Outlier. Engineer's degree (Master's), Efrei Paris, Aug 2026. Azure certified (AZ-900, AI-900).

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Bash

AI and Machine Learning: LLMs, generative AI, agentic AI, RAG, vector stores, context engineering, fine-tuning (LoRA/PEFT), RLHF, prompt engineering, LLM evaluation, hallucination detection, NLP, low-resource languages, AutoML, MLOps; PyTorch, Hugging Face, LangChain, scikit-learn, DeepEval, Optuna, Whisper, Streamlit

AI Tooling: Claude (Anthropic), Claude Code (CLAUDE.md, slash commands, hooks, MCP servers), ChatGPT, Gemini, Mistral API, Groq, OpenRouter

Cloud and DevOps: AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions), Linux, Git

Backend, Frontend, Data: FastAPI, Node.js, Express.js, Next.js, React, Tailwind, REST APIs, webhooks, n8n, Pinecone, Upstash Redis, PostgreSQL

Testing and Methodology: Robot Framework, Pytest, Squash TM, Ranorex, Selenium, Cypress, BDD/Gherkin, Postman, Newman, JMeter, SoapUI, parallel test execution, TDD, Agile

Spoken Languages: French (native), English (C1, TOEIC 815/990), Mooré (native)

EXPERIENCE

Founder and CEO, **Zaka**

2025 to Present

- Founded Zaka, a real estate marketplace for Burkina Faso, live across 9+ cities. Two-sided model: B2B agent and agency network for sales, rentals, and commercial, plus C2B consumer requests routed to agencies.
- Wired the platform into Burkina Faso's official land documentation system (SIF) so every listing ties back to a verified land title. No other African real estate platform offers this.

QA Automation & Test Engineering Apprentice, **Informatique CDC** (Caisse des Dépôts)

08/2023 to 08/2026

- Built and shipped an internal test automation platform integrating JIRA, Squash TM, Ranorex, Robot Framework, Jenkins, and Docker. Migrated the QA stack from proprietary Ranorex to open-source Robot Framework. Adopted by 20+ testers across 3 teams. Saved 20K EUR/year in license costs.
- Built XploreAI, an R&D autonomous testing agent that generates exploratory test scenarios from a single URL using OpenAI. Cut manual exploratory test setup time and demonstrated AI-driven QA to leadership.
- Built an in-house AI tool (Mistral API, RAG, prompt engineering) that auto-generates Gherkin/BDD scripts from Squash specs. Flipped QA testers from writers to reviewers and cut time-to-first-test on new features.
- Cut Gherkin pipeline deploy time 50% (60 to 30 min) by parallelizing tests on GitLab CI. Shipped uTest, an internal CLI orchestrating end-to-end runs across web, mobile, API, and performance test layers. Trained engineers and non-technical staff on the toolchain.

Software Engineering Resident, **Headstarter** (AI Residency)

09/2024 to 02/2025

- Shipped 14+ production AI apps under weekly sprints: RAG pipelines, fine-tuned LLMs, autonomous agents, Next.js/TypeScript apps. Deployed on AWS and Vercel with isolated dev/prod environments.
- Engineered Autonomous ML Agent, an LLM-driven AutoML platform (Claude/GPT/Gemini via OpenRouter) on Daytona sandboxes with Optuna Bayesian tuning, parallel training of 6+ models, and FastAPI + Docker delivery. Substack write-up.
- Fine-tuned and benchmarked 10+ LLMs (Llama, Mistral, Whisper) on the latency-vs-accuracy trade-off for real-time inference.

AI Code Expert (RLHF, Contract), **Outlier AI**

11/2024 to Present

- Run RLHF evaluations on frontier LLMs. Score code-generation quality on full GitHub projects in Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, plus Docker, Kubernetes, and CI/CD configs. Work feeds algorithm and data-structure benchmark training.
- Author scoring rubrics (10+ per task) and evaluation prompts; enforce PEP 8 and ESLint compliance across submitted samples.

PROJECTS

LLM Evaluation Platform - **Demo** | **Code**

01/2025 to 02/2025

- Streamlit + DeepEval app benchmarking Gemini Pro vs LLaMA (via Groq) in real time, with a RAG pipeline (PDF/DOCX/TXT on Pinecone) measuring context precision, recall, relevancy, hallucination rate, and source faithfulness.

Stack: Python, Streamlit, DeepEval, Pinecone, Gemini API, Groq.

SaChi-ASR, Whisper Fine-Tuned on Mooré (Low-Resource African Language) - **Model**

2024 to 2025

- Fine-tuned OpenAI Whisper on Mooré, a low-resource African language spoken in Burkina Faso, and published the model on Hugging Face; built sachi-App, a companion TTS / ASR web app for native speakers.

Stack: Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, Whisper.

AI Answer Engine, Open Source, 7+ GitHub Stars - **Demo** | **Code**

11/2024 to 12/2024

- Perplexity-style answer engine on Gemini Flash 2.0 with multi-source RAG (YouTube transcripts, PDFs, web pages, images, CSV), source citations, auto chart generation via Chart.js, and Upstash Redis for rate limiting and shareable sessions.

Stack: Next.js 14, TypeScript, Gemini API, Upstash Redis, Tailwind CSS, Puppeteer.

Pentagram - Self-Hosted Image Generation - **Demo** | **Code**

12/2024 to 01/2025

- Self-hosted Stable Diffusion XL Turbo on Modal A10G GPUs (no vendor API) for 2-second end-to-end generation. Pipeline: Next.js -> Modal GPU -> SDXL-Turbo -> Vercel Blob -> client, with per-stage latency budgets.

Stack: Next.js 14, TypeScript, Modal (NVIDIA A10G), SDXL-Turbo, Vercel Blob.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree (Engineer's Degree), Computer Science - Networks and Security (major) / Cloud (second major), **Efrei Paris**

08/2023 to 08/2026 (expected)

- Selected coursework: Network Security, DevOps, AWS, Azure, Big Data, Management.

International Exchange Program, **Yuan Ze University**, Taiwan (6 months)

09/2025 to 02/2026

- Coursework: Data Science, Deep Learning, International MBA modules.

CERTIFICATIONS AND PUBLICATIONS

Certifications: Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900), Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), Microsoft Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500), in progress, ETS Global: TOEIC 815/990 (English). **Publications and Open Source:** Automated Machine Learning Pipeline - Substack write-up on the LLM-driven AutoML agent, 40+ public repositories on GitHub, spanning AI, DevOps, cloud security, and full-stack.